

Pebworth Piper

MARCH 2016



Pebworth Methodist Church 1965

EDITORIAL

There has been much recent activity at the old Chapel at the bottom of Front Street with the ancient interior flagstones being removed and excavations carried out.

We are unclear at present as to what is being done so a brief history of its origins might be interesting.

'There had been a long Methodist tradition in the parish since the 18th century when Henry Eden, the principal landowner in Broad Marston and close friend of John Wesley, left £300 in his will in 1781 for the use of the Methodist church. In Pebworth, land was purchased in 1832 and a request was granted by the Chapel Buildings Committee for the erection of a chapel. The estimated cost was £120 of which £80 has already been donated for interior fittings. The chapel was opened in 1840.

In the religious census of 1851 Samuel Rastell, the steward, who owned the bakery and shop in Friday Street, reported that the average congregation was 150 and on March 31st 64 attended morning service with 75 at the evening service. The population at this time was about 400.

By 1880 Methodism here was in decline and the chapel had been closed for some time – "it presents a sorry sight with grass growing between the flagstones". A revival came in the same year when Thomas & Louisa Valender bought the bakery in Friday Street, having been driven from their bakery in Bidford by floods. After re-opening the chapel they formed a Sunday School and the chapel once more became a very important part of

village life until it closed in 1979. In our next issue we will share more memories of the part the chapel played in the lives of many Pebworth families.'

The Village Hall gate has been locked because of noise and nuisance activity during the hours of darkness and the hall grounds cut up by vehicles. Apologies to users of the hall but new gate keys will be attached to existing key rings.

The ancient wall in Front Street has been cordoned off as a precaution due to concerns regarding the safety of it.

PEBWORTH & DISTRICT WI



By the end of last month's meeting we were all sitting upright with our ankles uncrossed – Brigitte Nath had given us all a very clear explanation of the Dorn Method, a gentle method of realigning vertebrae which she had learned in Germany after suffering whiplash in a car accident. She had explained how incorrect posture affects muscles and internal organs and so how we sit and stand is vitally important for good health. Her practice is at the Stratford Garden Centre.

Instead of standing at the sink washing up we were delighted that the new village hall dish-washer worked perfectly – what a boon that is going to be at village events.

A large and colourful display of the articles made by members in the Knit and Natter group has encouraged us to keep knitting and members have been signing up for all the different craft classes which will be taking place this year ranging from printing to art, from crochet to sewing.

Other events to consider are a 'Saunter in the City' a guided tour of Birmingham city centre and a meeting with the Royal Navy at Pershore. The skittles team has been in action beating Peopleton in its first match and a group went to support the re-opening of Honeybourne WI. That is very good news, particularly as Mickleton WI has already re-opened this year. At the end of the meeting there was absolute silence for 5 minutes as we all tried to find as many words as possible from "osteoporosis" after a re-count a guest Karen had found over 40!

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CHAPEL
APRIL ~~MARCH~~ 2016

EDITORIAL

This month two VIP's are leaving the village. Our Vicar, Rev Debbie Foreman, is moving onto a new urban parish in Croydon. We wish her and Edward well for the future. Her last service is Sunday 3rd April 11am at Honeybourne.

Lead teacher at Pebworth First School, Zoe Nosworthy is retiring this term. She will be missed by the children. We send best wishes to her.

Pebworth Methodist Chapel continuing from last month...

The vestry was added to the building following the purchase of a small strip of land next to where Mr Box the Postman had stabled his horse and cart. The pulpit, from which Wesley had preached in St Peters, was handed down to the Wesleyan Methodists for use in the chapel.

Early in the 20th century a young men's Bible class was started by Miss Hamblin, laying a good and firm foundation for many lives. A notable feature of the work of the Church was a strong Band of Hope with concerns for evangelism and social service. This was a temperance society, like a youth club; Over 60 boys and girls met fortnightly. Juniors paid 1/2d and over 12 yrs 1d towards outings. They sang solos, hymns and recitations. Local outings travelling by Webbs carriers cart were to Bishops Cleeve Fun Park, Evesham, Bidford or Stratford for trip on the river.

A Sunday School 11-12noon with 20 to 30 children was run by 2 male and 3 female teachers. Mr Enoch Tracey assisted by Mr & Mrs Norman Harrison taught there. Sunday School Anniversaries were popular with child soloists singing. The three front rows would be full of children. Heating sometimes caused a problem if the wind was in the wrong direction, when the heating stove would fill the place with smoke, much to the caretaker, Mrs Sheward's consternation. Young people also eagerly participated in other events in the circuit. When restrictions were lifted in 1945 annual prize giving books were given out.

Millicent Harrison played the organ for services from 1926, having preceded her sister Clare, and was presented with a china cabinet in 1976 for 50 years service.

Some of the past worshippers were Valender, Sheward, Tracey, Taylor, Harrison.

During 1936/37 there were thirteen chapels in the circuit, Wyre, Evesham, Bidford, Welford, Long Marston, Upper Quinton, Mickleton, Ilmington, Campden, Honeybourne, Willersey, and Broadway and Pebworth and 35 local preachers, two services Sunday and usually one midweek. Four local preachers lived in the village.

In latter years combined services and Harvest Festivals were enjoyed with the church congregation. Members entered the village flower shows with a flower, fruit and vegetable stand. Their mixed choir entered the circuit festivals and won a shield in 1925. The chapel was registered for weddings in 1910. Two of the last weddings held were Mary & Peter Harrison in 1961 and Mary's sister in 1964.

Due to falling numbers it was decided to close and some of the congregation then attended Mickleton Chapel. The last service was well attended and remembered by present day residents with affection. It was sold at auction in 1980's having been used as a Studio and is now owned by The Messerschmitt Club.

KEEPING PEBWORTH CLEAN FOR THE QUEEN

Hard work put in by over 60 volunteers to keep the village litter free this year. As well as weekly collections by our litter leads, the WI has been organising a litter pick for over 20 years, always on the first Saturday in March. This year the weather was good once again and with the very active support of Pebworth in Bloom, bags and bags of rubbish were collected from the verges and out of ditches. The amount of alcohol related debris is disgraceful and larger items blocking the ditches is completely thoughtless. Ditches need to be clear to prevent flooding. The worst offenders are undoubtedly motorists eating in their vehicles and then throwing out sandwich wrappers, takeaway bags and bottles, crisp packets and chocolate wrappers. Posters, designed by Dan Harding, Dorsington Rd are now up at the worst places – perhaps they will prick some people's consciences!